

Payment Chronicle by Gajanan

March 21, 2026

Companies: Square, Adyen

Article 1

Please share the full Adyen announcement to craft an accurate summary

The snippet you've shared cuts off before the key news—so we don't yet know what Adyen announced on July 12, 2022 in San Francisco. To deliver a crisp Finshots-style take (what happened, why it matters, and the strategic implications for payments execs), I'll need the core details: what Adyen launched or announced (product/partnership/expansion), the geographies affected, any numbers (merchant wins, pricing, volumes, take rate impact), and why this move matters (e.g., competition with Stripe/PayPal, push into embedded finance, omnichannel ambitions, or margins). Share the full press release or a few bullet points and I'll turn it into a 150–200 word, witty, plain English summary with a sharp headline.

Source: PaymentsJournal

<https://www.paymentsjournal.com/adyen-goes-live-with-tap-to-pay-on-iphone/>

Article 2

Adyen taps Plaid to bring pay by bank closer to checkout primetime

Adyen just teamed up with Plaid to make bank to bank payments a smoother option at checkout. In plain English: Adyen will handle processing and reconciliation, while Plaid supplies the pipes that connect shoppers' bank accounts and the smarts to verify them instantly. The pitch to merchants is familiar but timely—bank payments can be cheaper than cards and come with fewer chargebacks, but clunky account verification and NSF risks have held them back. Plaid helps nix the friction; Adyen packages it neatly alongside cards and wallets in one integration. Why it matters: As card fees creep up and margins get squeezed, high ticket, recurring, and bill pay use cases are hunting for lower cost rails. If Adyen can make “pay by bank” feel as effortless and safe as card-on-file, it could pry open a small but growing slice of checkout volume. There are caveats—settlement timing, refunds, and consumer habit remain hurdles. And rivals aren't asleep: Stripe, Checkout.com, and GoCardless are running similar plays. But for Plaid, this is a step from data plumbing to payments monetization; for Adyen, it's stickier merchants and one more lever to defend take rates without a race to the bottom.

Source: PaymentsJournal

<https://www.paymentsjournal.com/adyen-and-plaid-partnership-what-it-means/>

Article 3

Adyen positions for BNPL holiday surge as Klarna fans demand

Buy now, pay later (BNPL) is set for another holiday growth spurt, and that's quietly good news for Adyen. With Swedish giant Klarna fueling shopper appetite for pay in 4 at checkout, the Dutch processor stands to ride the volume wave. Adyen already pipes BNPL options like Klarna, Afterpay and Affirm into merchant checkouts across markets. More shoppers splitting bills typically lifts conversion and basket sizes—translating into higher processed volumes and net revenue for Adyen—without the credit risk that BNPL providers shoulder. It also sharpens Adyen's "one platform, many methods" pitch: merchants prefer a single integration to toggle local wallets, cards and BNPL across geographies, which makes Adyen stickier versus rivals. The catch? Regulators are circling. Emerging rules in the US, UK and EU could cap fees, tighten disclosures and bring chargeback-like protections to BNPL, nudging economics and workflows for everyone in the chain. Net-net: if consumers swipe less and split more this season, Adyen wins on throughput and merchant retention—so long as regulatory tweaks don't dull BNPL's checkout appeal in 2025.

Source: PaymentsJournal

<https://www.paymentsjournal.com/klarna-and-adyen-team-up-for-in-store-bnpl/>

Article 4

Square's new Handheld cuts the phone out of point of sale

Square made its name by turning your smartphone into a card reader. Now it wants you to skip the phone altogether. Its new "Handheld" is a purpose-built, all-in-one POS device with a built-in reader and Square software that's designed for moving queues, tableside ordering, and curbside checkout—without relying on an employee's iPhone or Android. For merchants, that means fewer variables: no dead personal batteries, no OS update surprises, better durability, and one vendor for hardware, software, and support. For Square, it tightens the ecosystem lock, standardizes the checkout experience, and creates another hardware beachhead to bundle subscriptions like Restaurants, Retail, loyalty, and staff management. Strategically, it's Square answering Toast's rugged handhelds and Shopify's POS Go, and hedging against the limits of "Tap to Pay" software-only terminals. The bigger picture: the small-merchant checkout war is shifting from dongles to integrated handhelds, where control of hardware plus software can defend take rates, reduce PCI headaches, and deepen data moats. If you sell payments to SMBs, expect more device-led bundles, faster deployments—and stickier customers.

Source: PaymentsJournal

<https://www.paymentsjournal.com/square-aims-to-move-upmarket-with-handheld-pos-device/>

Article 5

Square tests Bitcoin at the till as Compass Coffee brews first sale

Square just took its Bitcoin ambitions from app to counter. A Compass Coffee in Washington, D.C. processed the first in-store bitcoin payment using Square's new point-of-sale feature — a small sip that could hint at a bigger brew for merchant acceptance. For payment execs, the signal is clear: Square wants to make crypto a mainstream tender alongside cards and cash. The pitch is familiar — attract crypto-native customers, potentially trim acceptance costs, and offer a new rail outside traditional networks. But the real test isn't the headline; it's the plumbing. How fast is checkout? Who eats network fees? Does Square auto-convert to dollars to dodge volatility, and how are refunds or disputes handled in a world without chargebacks? There's also the boring stuff: tax treatment, accounting, reconciliation, and staff training. If Square smooths those edges and delivers a tap-simple experience, Bitcoin at the POS could become a niche differentiator for high-fee categories or marketing-savvy brands. If not, it's a photogenic pilot. Either way, card networks and acquirers should watch closely — new rails are knocking on the register.

Source: PaymentsJournal

<https://www.paymentsjournal.com/squares-platform-sees-first-bitcoin-payment-at-coffee-shop/>

Article 6

Square lets merchants take Bitcoin — here's why it matters

Square is adding bitcoin payment acceptance to its seller tools, just as small businesses feel the heat to keep up with flashy new tech. The pitch is simple: let customers pay in bitcoin, while merchants can choose to auto-convert to local currency and avoid the price swings. For sellers, this is less about tomorrow's revenue and more about signaling—think of it as a low-cost “we're future-ready” badge at checkout. The near-term volumes will likely be tiny, but the real action is in economics and plumbing: crypto rails can sidestep some traditional card costs, offer instant(ish) settlement, and open cross-border options. The flip side? Compliance, refunds, accounting, and customer support all get trickier, and consumers still overwhelmingly prefer cards and wallets. For Block, it tightens the loop between Cash App's crypto users and Square's merchants, boosting ecosystem stickiness. For incumbents, it's another nudge to rethink rails as acceptance broadens beyond cards. Bottom line: this won't dethrone Visa tomorrow, but it gives SMBs optionality, puts pressure on fees over time, and inches crypto from PR stunt to practical checkout choice.

Source: PaymentsJournal

<https://www.paymentsjournal.com/square-adds-bitcoin-payments-and-upgrades-ai-for-small-businesses/>

